

MiniMax-M3 on OpenRouter

Step-by-step setup & usage guide (free tier)

Base URL

```
https://openrouter.ai/api/v1
```

Step 1 — Create your account

Go to openrouter.ai and sign up with Google, GitHub, or email. No credit card required for free models.

Step 2 — Find MiniMax-M3

Go to openrouter.ai/models and search “MiniMax-M3”, or browse the Free Models collection at openrouter.ai/collections/free-models. The free version will show **:free** in its model ID or be clearly tagged.

Step 3 — Check the model ID

Click into the model page and copy its exact model slug — it'll look like `minimax/minimax-m3:free`. You need this exact string later.

Step 4 — Test it free in the browser first

Use OpenRouter's Chatroom (openrouter.ai/chat) to try MiniMax-M3 directly, no code needed. Good sanity check before wiring it into anything.

Step 5 — Get your API key

Go to openrouter.ai/keys, click “Create Key,” name it, and copy it immediately (it starts with `sk-or-` and won't be shown again).

Step 6 — Set up the connection in code

If you're using the OpenAI SDK (Python or JS), you only change 3 things — key, base URL, model name. See the code block below.

```
import OpenAI from 'openai';

const openai = new OpenAI({
  baseURL: 'https://openrouter.ai/api/v1',
  apiKey: 'sk-or-YOUR_KEY_HERE',
});

const completion = await openai.chat.completions.create({
  model: 'minimax/minimax-m3:free',
  messages: [{ role: 'user', content: 'Hello!' }],
```

```
});
```

Step 7 — Or plug it into a tool like Cline/Cursor

In the tool's settings, find “API Key” or “Custom Provider,” paste your OpenRouter key, set the base URL to `https://openrouter.ai/api/v1`, and pick `minimax/minimax-m3:free` from the model list (or type it manually if not listed yet).

Step 8 — Watch your limits

Free models on OpenRouter have rate limits (usually per-minute and per-day caps) and can be adjusted or pulled at any time — check the model page occasionally so you're not caught off guard.

Notes: MiniMax-M3 supports a 1M-token context window and multimodal input (text, image, video) and is well suited to long-horizon agentic work, coding, and tool use. Free-tier availability and rate limits can change without notice — always confirm on the model's OpenRouter page before relying on it in production.